



# Marie Curie



Marie Curie is remembered around the world for her discovery of radium and polonium, and for her contributions to finding treatments for cancer. She was a pioneering female scientist who used physics to save lives.

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Marie Curie developed her love of science at an early age. She was born in Poland in 1867. Her father was a math and physics teacher. To study physics at university, Marie moved to Paris, France.

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In the late 1890s, together with her husband, Pierre Curie, she discovered two new radioactive elements; polonium and radium. Radioactive elements give off unending rays of energy. She named Polonium after her home country, Poland.

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In 1903, Marie and Pierre, shared with another scientist, the Nobel Prize in physics for their work on radioactivity. Marie then discovered how to isolate radium from the rock in which it is found. For this work, she won the Nobel Prize for chemistry.

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Science and industry quickly found important uses for these radioactive elements, including the development of x-rays of the human body.

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After World War I, Marie continued her studies in radioactive substances. Her Radium Institute in Paris was important for scientific research in this subject. Sadly, Marie did not know that working with radioactive materials could make her unwell. She died of cancer in 1934.

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Marie was the first woman in the world to win any kind of Nobel Prize. She was the first person to win two Nobel Prizes. Today, Marie Curie continues to be an inspiration for her breakthroughs in science.

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